

Ancient Rome

More than 2,000 years ago, ancient Rome was one of the most powerful nations in the world. At first, Rome was ruled by kings. It became a republic in 509 BCE, which meant that it was ruled by members of Roman society. In 27 BCE Rome became an empire, led by a ruler called an emperor. At its largest, in 117 CE, the Roman Empire was home to more than 65 million people.

Punic Wars

Between 264 and 146 BCE, Rome fought three wars against the city of Carthage, in modern-day Tunisia. Rome wanted control of the Mediterranean Sea. The wars, known as the Punic Wars, ended in total Roman victory.



General Hannibal from Carthage

KEY (c. 117 CE)



Empire border

The edge of the Roman Empire.



Grain

Shipped to Rome from North Africa and Sicily.



Grapevines

Vines were planted across the empire to grow grapes to make into wine.



Timber

Forests were stripped of wood all over the empire.



Roman baths

Public bathing brought the Romans together.



Slaves

Many Romans owned slaves. Some slaves had to build Roman roads.



Amphitheaters

Open-air theaters entertained Romans across the empire.



Roman soldiers

The army kept the peace and defended the borders against enemy invasion.

Named after Emperor Hadrian, work on this wall began in 122 CE. It marked the northwest edge of the empire.

Hadrian's Wall

This leader of the Arverni tribe led an uprising against Roman power in 52 BCE.

Vercingetorix

The Romans built this lighthouse in what is now Spain.

Tower of Hercules

This was the most important gold mine in the Roman Empire.

Las Medulas

Pont du Gard

The Romans built aqueducts to transport water from one place to another.

Carthaginians

The Carthaginians used war elephants to fight against the Roman Empire.

Julius Caesar

One of ancient Rome's most well-known leaders, Julius Caesar conquered large amounts of land for Rome. The empire began with his great-nephew, Augustus, who made himself the first emperor.

